



# UTUMISHI ACADEMY

*Strive For Excellence And Honour*

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DATE: September 27, 2017.

Dear admissions committee,

**RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR JEFF MAINA GITAH, ADM. NO. 3550, INDEX NO. 27500008003.**

It is with great pleasure and utmost honor that I recommend Jeff, a phenomenal and remarkable student, for admission to your university. I got the chance to interact, positively impact and partake in the life and unique personality of Jeff during the four years that he studied and bequeathed a legacy to the whole Utumishi community as a whole. I was his high school principal, counselor and by far a friend to him I would say from the deep connection we shared throughout his time in school. Getting to experience his positive growth, exceptional personality and influential impact on the school community was an experience that is and will be deeply engraved in my life and teaching career.

From the first impression, Jeff struck me as a charismatic, confident, self-driven, innovative and with a desire and willpower to achieve in everything that he set his mind to do. Jeff was able to draw attention from the teachers hardly into his first week due to his innate articulate ability to express himself and the energy and enthusiasm he put into all school activities. Despite being a new student, his insightful contribution and extrovert nature made him approachable by most students and staff and he would leave a positive mark on whoever's life he touched.

Jeff was a student of exceptional academic talent and prowess since inception. He was an active participant in all of his classes and received various accolades. His unique style of learning was, however, what made him truly outstanding. The fact that that he would draw knowledge from helping out other students grasp concepts and embracing this task with genuine interest. I remember during one time when he came into my office and during our conversation he made a witty remark that he does not need to read a concept or topic to understand it, he just needs to help another student get the concept and that would do the magic for him! It was not a surprise when he emerged one of the best students in the country during his final Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education exams.

His social conscious nature and terrific ability to relate to other students were able to bring out his leadership abilities. Jeff was one of the only two students who was elected and retained their position in the school's student council throughout their four years in the school, a historical feat. Jeff had a unique sense of responsibility and reverence to his various leadership roles and displayed willpower to start and influence positive change in the school. He struck me as a transformative leader when he and other two prefects approached my office with a well detailed and analyzed proposal to change the bread-issuing system from manual register to an innovative technological system. Jeff was passionate about the idea and his persuasive and critical thinking was vibrantly outstanding as he pitched the idea to the school board. The idea was conceptualized and it was able to save time and resources up to this very day. Jeff's ability to balance leadership and academics was remarkable at the very least.

Jeff struck me as a pacesetter by his self-initiative to undertake to transform the school publication, the county sheriff. His unique and embrative writing spectacle made him cut himself a niche as a top writer in our school becoming part of the editing team on his first year. Jeff was able to bring out issues facing our community in a way that all could relate and especially his deep love for the school and environment sparking laughter through his hilarious and impactful style of writing. All the teachers, including me, looked forward to reading his excerpts and he went ahead to bring glory to our school by winning writing competitions including the Postbank competition with his article on 'why financial literacy is vital for us teens' which I saw as a mature and truly informative piece showcasing his character.

Jeff has a deep love for exploring new activities and embracing new tasks with enthusiasm and willingness to explore his imagination and his somehow 'nerdy' side. It was no surprise to see his active participation in math, peer teaching, and writing clubs. I remember when in his second year he approached me asking for permission to attend electricity classes during his free time even though he was not taking that class. He later took up the task to revive our nearly obsolete 'innovation science club' and working under the immense pressure to influence students to join him even approaching a teacher to be the patron. He was able to successfully coordinate the activities of the group and what was amazing was the fact that they participated and went up to the regionals of the Kenya Science and Engineering Fair for three consecutive years. Jeff's electricity project was remarkable especially because of how he overcame the many setbacks and limited time while preparing the project.

His growth in the school both in terms of physical, social and emotional was exceptional mostly due to his openness and readiness to accept mistakes and correction. He would visit my office countless times and was not afraid to articulate his predicaments and was a good listener to advice from the seniors. He would apologize for his mistakes and take it upon himself to correct them. I came to note his insightful and goal-oriented mind when we sat together in the joint student and teacher academic committee by the way he would put forth ideas that would better the students' socio-academic lives. He would use personal experience and act as a team leader while not forcing out his ideas but making his voice stand out which I considered unique for a student of his age.

His interpersonal skills were further anchored by his vibrant nature. Jeff was a well-distributed student in all areas and was a good basketball player. During his third year, he fell and fractured his arm during the last basketball practice before the season started. He surprised me by insisting on attending the games with a cast on his arm. He was the unofficial mascot that inspired the school's team to win their games during that day from the bench. He brought together all students stimulating the school spirit.

Jeff was truly a trailblazer and an icon to many and his impact is still reverberating to those who came to know him and interact with him like I did. I would wholeheartedly recommend him to your university and can assure you with no iota of doubt that he will positively impact deeply into your university as he did to our institution. Mark my words, Jeff is the next big thing for your university!

**Sincerely,**

**Maina S. Gitonga.**

**SENIOR PRINCIPAL/SECRETARY BOG/PA.**

**UTUMISHI BOYS ACADEMY.**